Break Break Break

The poem is written by, The great victorian poet Alfred Tennyson. In this poem, he is lamenting the death of his close friend Arthur Hallam. This poem is called elegy because he is aware that his dear friend will never return and he can never hear his voice anymore. He also remembers the happy moments that they've shared together. So, now he only has memories left.

In stanza one of the poem, we see that, he is repeating the word 'Break'. This indicates that he is watching the breaking of the waves continuously on the shore. The movement of the waves is communicated by the repetition of the word 'Break'. The sea shore is rocky and the waves are falling on it by this he conveys that the feelings inside its mind are so melencholy that they resembles the 'cold gray stones' on the sea shore.

His feelings are captured inside his mind, are totally supressed. He is unable to express them because of the great sorrow, in his mind.
He wishes that, he is able to give and outlet to the feelings which are suppressed.

In the second stanza, the poet introduces two images - 'the fisherman's boy' and 'sister', 'sailor lad' & 'boat'.
As the poet is standing on the high rocks on the sea shore he can see around him. He saw that a young boy and his sister who belonged to the fisherman family can pray about and shout at each other, without any worries.
The second imaze is that of a young sailor who is singing as he brings his boats towards the bay. By this two images the poet is contrasting the happy condition of the children, with his own mental state. Even though he does not mention it yet, the reader can understand the feeling of regret in his mind.

The image in the third stanza is that of the big ships which continue there journey.
No one has stopped like him, as the ships move on they reach the shelter under the hill this symbolise that there journey has succesfully come to a close, they have had 'a happy ending' (unlike the poet).
After watching scenary around him, in his mind his sorrow reminds him of the warm touch of his friend's hand, which has vanished forever.
He also remembers the sound of his strange voice that has become permanently silent.

He starts the last stanza with the same words with which he had began the poem he is looking at the breaking of the waves again, the rocks are very sharp, meaning that the sea shore is full of sharp rocks and there are clips of the hill.

Inspite of the beauty of nature around him, the poet cannot overcome his grief. He remembers that the happy times are lost and the friendship and companionship are all 'dead.'
those happy memories of the times spent with his friend-s are described by 'the tender grace'.
the word 'day' is not talking about a single day, it refers to all the years he had spent in the company of his friend - which have remain only as memories.
In conclusion we can see that Tennyson accepts the fact that the lost time and his happiness can never be recovered or experienced again. It has no option but to live the rest of his life keeping his friend inside his heart.